

Postdoctoral Award eligibility and what you can apply for

Learn about the scope and eligibility of our Postdoctoral Award. Find out if you are eligible to apply for a Postdoctoral Award funding opportunity and see what we fund.

Who is eligible to apply

You can apply to this award from any postdoctoral career stage, from recent PhD completion through to several years' postdoctoral experience.

To be eligible, you must:

- hold a relevant PhD or MD, or have submitted your thesis for examination at the time of application
 - you must have been awarded your PhD or MD by the time you attend the interview
- propose to undertake the award at a higher education institute, NHS body, local authority or other provider of health or social care services, either in England or a participating devolved nation
- not already hold a chair position at the point of application
- must have completed relevant pre-registration training if you are a clinical applicant
- propose a research project that is within [our remit for personal career development awards](/career-development/nih-academy/remit-personal-awards) (/career-development/nih-academy/remit-personal-awards)

If you hold a professional doctorate, you must contact us before you start your application and we will help to confirm your eligibility.

Career stage

You can apply for the award if you:

- have recently completed or are soon to be awarded a PhD but have not yet established yourself as an independent researcher
- are beginning to establish yourself as an independent researcher, or you are already independent, but you are not yet recognised as an international leader in your field
- are looking to transition into applied health or social care research from a basic science or non-health or care research background
- are returning to research after a significant career break

Applicants making a transition

You can use a Postdoctoral Award to support a transition into applied health and social care research. This may be from an area of basic science or non-health or social care related research into a research area within our remit. You must clearly articulate how your proposed research project and training and development programme will enable you to make the transition. You should also describe the impact it will have on your research career.

You can also use the award to transition to become a future health and social care research leader competent in clinical trials. Your application should include a period of intense training in a wide range of subjects relevant to clinical trials. We encourage you to partner with a clinical trials unit (CTU) and undertake masters-level training where appropriate. Our [clinical trials guidance](/clinical-trials-guide) (/clinical-trials-guide) provides further information.

Overseas applicants

We are unable to support your application if you are living overseas from your contracting organisation.

You must be based in England, or a participating devolved nation, at your contracting organisation for the duration of the award. Travel that is necessary to undertake research, training or development activities and is outlined in your application is permitted.

Knowledge mobilisation research proposal

We are looking for innovative proposals that seek to increase the effective use of research knowledge while simultaneously researching implementation processes. Your proposal should aim to advance knowledge and understanding about research use, influence and impact through practice and systematic study.

Your proposal will most likely involve collaboration with research teams. It should either build on the work of a single project or link multiple related projects to support knowledge mobilisation within a particular field, and users of the research within health and social care settings.

Research and evaluation that is embedded within your award may make contributions to research-based knowledge on knowledge mobilisation. This might also happen through collaboration with research partners over the lifetime of the project. This award supports both improving research use and advancing understanding of its influence and impact.

[Learn more about knowledge mobilisation \(/research-funding/application-support/plan-knowledge-mobilisation\)](#)

Devolved administrations

The participation of devolved administrations is specific to each funding opportunity. Visit the funding opportunity page that you are applying to for more information.

Resubmissions

You can apply twice for a Postdoctoral Award:

- if your first application is unsuccessful you must wait 12 months before resubmitting
- if both of your applications are unsuccessful, you must wait 3 years before reapplying
 - this break will allow you to develop your CV and experience
- if you have submitted an unsuccessful application to the Future Leaders Fellowship or a predecessor award, it does not count towards your 2-attempt limit
 - our predecessor awards are the Advanced Clinical and Practitioner Academic Fellowship, Advanced Local Authority Fellowship or Advanced Fellowship

What the Postdoctoral Award funds

This award funds:

- your salary as the lead applicant, including clinical service or practice time
- the cost of a tailored academic and professional development programme
- an annual conference budget
- research project costs which can include:
 - a support post salary, including £3,000 towards their training and development
 - shared research staff
 - dissemination costs

You can have 2 sequential postdoctoral awards, or equivalent predecessor schemes, with a combined duration of up to 8 years.

Award duration

You can apply for 2 to 5 years of flexible funding. We offer full-time and part-time options.

[Find out more about award durations \(/personal-career-development-award-durations\)](/personal-career-development-award-durations)

What the Postdoctoral Award does not fund

The award does not fund:

- contributions for individuals providing support and mentorship, including:
 - mentors
 - supervisors
 - practice supervisors named in the application
 - administrative or secretarial support
- whole or significant percentages of support posts over and above those permitted
- technical or research support staff whose costs are funded through institutional indirect costs (HEIs only)
- mentor travel expenses
- we reserve the right to question excessive costs

Partnership awards

We are partnering with a number of charitable organisations to offer jointly funded NIHR charity partnership awards.

[Partnership awards](/career-development/nihhr-academy/partnership-awards) (/career-development/nihhr-academy/partnership-awards) offer the benefits of an NIHR training award, such as becoming an [NIHR Academy Member](/career-development/nihhr-academy/nihhr-academy-member-benefits) (/career-development/nihhr-academy/nihhr-academy-member-benefits), as well as the additional advantages that funding through the named charity can offer. For example, you might be able to engage with charity patient groups and increase the exposure of research outcomes and outputs.

Visit the funding opportunity page you are apply to for information on which organisations are offering a partnership award.



Who and what we have funded

See case studies and stories showing who has previously held a Postdoctoral Award.

Related awards and programmes

We offer a [range of personal research career development awards \(/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes\)](/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes) including:

[Doctoral Award \(/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/doctoral-fellowships\)](/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/doctoral-fellowships)

[Predoctoral Award \(/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/predoctoral/predoctoral-award\)](/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/predoctoral/predoctoral-award)

[Future Leaders Fellowship \(/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/postdoctoral/clinical-future-leaders-fellowship\)](/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/postdoctoral/clinical-future-leaders-fellowship)

[Efficacy and Mechanism Evaluation Postdoctoral Award \(/funding/eme-postdoctoral-award/2025305\)](/funding/eme-postdoctoral-award/2025305)

[Health Technology Assessment Postdoctoral Award \(/funding/hta-postdoctoral-award/2025304\)](/funding/hta-postdoctoral-award/2025304)

More information and contact

[Postdoctoral Award: how to apply \(/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/postdoctoral/postdoctoral-award/how-to-apply\)](/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/postdoctoral/postdoctoral-award/how-to-apply)

[Postdoctoral Award: overview \(/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/postdoctoral/postdoctoral-award\)](/career-development/research-career-funding-programmes/postdoctoral/postdoctoral-award)

Contact us

Contact us if you have questions about the programme. Raise issues about completing a funding application online through our awards management system.

Telephone:

[0113 532 8444](tel:01135328444) (tel:01135328444)

Email:

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